SAMPLE DOCUMENT

Tracking Update Spike Playbook

A 7-step plan for a sudden wave of tracking emails

Situation

Many customers suddenly write “my tracking hasn’t updated”. Follow these steps so the team stays calm, consistent and honest.

1. **Confirm the spike**
   Compare today’s volume with a normal day. Check 10 sample orders in the carrier system.
2. **Find the cause**
   Carrier delay, scan outage, system sync issue or holiday volume. Write one line for the team.
3. **Tag every ticket**
   Use one tag, for example tracking-update, so the spike can be counted.
4. **Send one approved reply**
   Short apology, honest status, when the next update comes. No promises you cannot keep.
5. **Sort by days waiting**
   1-3 days: reassure. 4-7 days with no scan: open a carrier inquiry. 8+ days: offer replacement or refund per policy.
6. **Get ahead of it**
   Send a proactive email or update the help page and auto-reply so fewer customers need to write.
7. **Hand over and review**
   Share counts in the daily handover. After the spike, update the template and note what to do faster next time.

TIP: Never promise a delivery date you cannot confirm. Day thresholds are examples, adjust them to your carrier and policy.

Sample - no real company or customer data